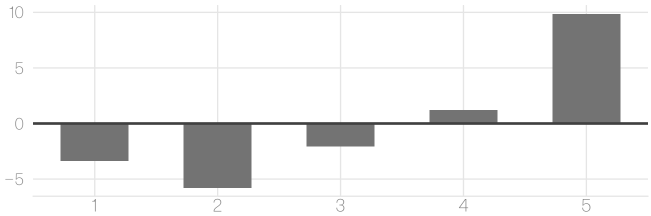
Retail Flow

Quantifies retail money flow, positioning, and activity and systematically takes contrarian positions.

MEAN ALPHA BY QUANTILE · 1D (BPS)



"Retail Flow" cross-sectional factor is designed to measure and respond to retail investor activity.

By analyzing individual executed trades sourced from exchanges, the strategy identifies assets heavily influenced by retail participation. It then takes systematically contrarian positions, seeking to exploit predictable patterns of overreaction and herding behavior.

Order sizes and types are utilized to differentiate between retail and institutional activity. To quantify trade imbalances on the filtered trades, five distinct techniques are employed, their outputs are normalized and combined in an ensemble approach, without any optimization or parameter fitting.

The asset universe consists of the most liquid and actively traded assets, identified on rolling basis - various techniques employed to keep it both stable and relevant, as well as survivorship-bias free.

To balance each asset's risk contribution, positions are scaled according to the inverse of their rolling volatility.

The factor is available (point-in-time) with hourly updates, 5 minutes past the hour (UTC).

EXAMPLE TOP 40 CROSS-SECTIONAL PORTFOLIO

Inception Nov 2020 · Updated Apr 2026

Long and short the full Top 40 universe, with position sizes scaled by the factor's cross-sectional strength. Rebalanced daily.

PERFORMANCE

Gross Rate of Return

1M	3M	1Y	3Y	5Y
−0.9%	1.0%	0.4%	67.8%	165.9%

Annual Performance (%)

2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	YTD
9.5%	180.7%	−10.1%	29.0%	22.2%	−3.8%	8.9%

Since Inception

SI
355.7%

RISK & RETURN PROFILE

Realised Volatility (annualised)

1M	3M	1Y	3Y
14.1%	22.6%	21.8%	24.3%

Return-to-Risk Ratio

1M	3M	1Y	3Y
−0.07	0.04	0.02	2.80

Max Drawdown

%	Date
−33.6%	2021-02-28

CUMULATIVE RETURN

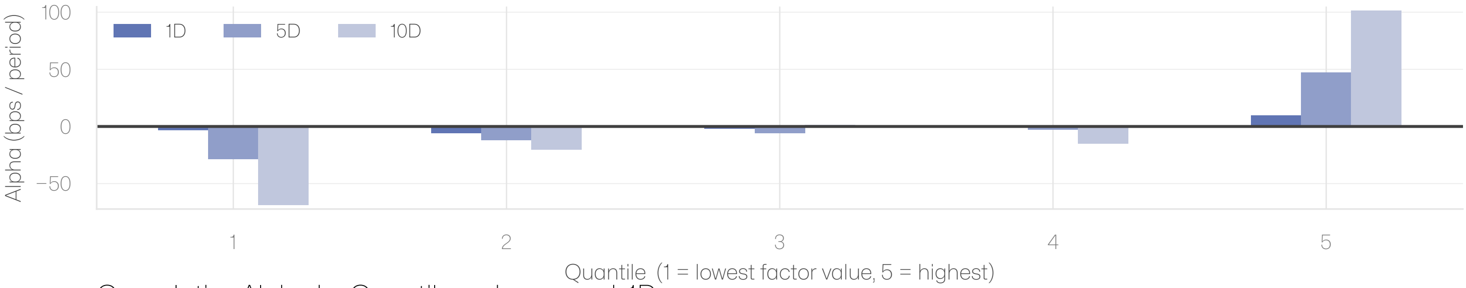
Note – Performance is for an illustrative single-factor portfolio (positions sized proportionally to the factor signal across the Top 40 universe, rebalanced daily); demonstrative only, not a tradable product. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

Factor Analysis

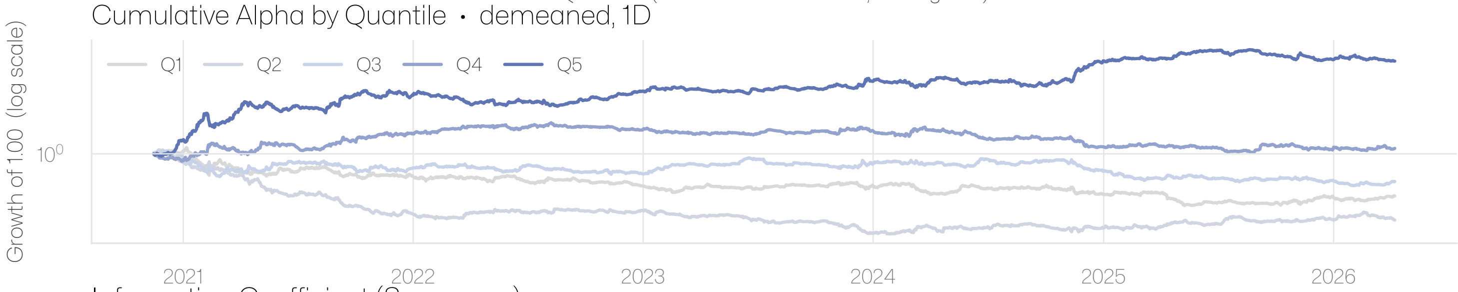
Diagnostics on the raw factor values, independent of portfolio construction. The quintile and IC plots show whether the signal cross-sectionally separates outperformers from underperformers – and how consistently.

Computed on the rolling Top 40 universe – membership reconstructed point-in-time on each date to avoid look-ahead bias. The factor itself covers a much larger universe of tokens (see the raw factor-data CSV in the data room).

Mean Forward Return by Quantile · demeaned

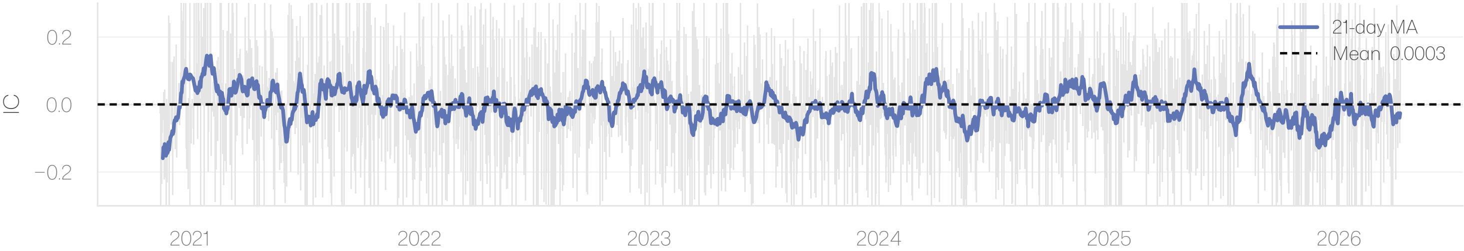


Cumulative Alpha by Quantile · demeaned, 1D



Information Coefficient (Spearman)

Mean 0.0003 · Std 0.1988 · IR 0.00 · 50.3% positive · 1D



ABOUT UNRAVEL

Unravel publishes a catalog of cross-sectional, market-neutral crypto factors, each delivered with point-in-time historical data and live signals. Individual factors are designed to be combined: blended into a multi-factor portfolio they diversify away single-factor risk and produce a steadier return stream than any one factor alone. Explore the full catalog, the multi-factor construction methodology and API access at unravel.finance – see the further materials linked below.

View this factor on unravel.finance →

Replication notebook – full AlphaLens analysis →

NOTICE & DISCLAIMER